VILLAGE FOR HER

The Village Kit

Care, made easier to coordinate.

A practical support-planning toolkit for asking, organizing, giving, and receiving meaningful help.

USE IT FOR

- clarifying what would help
- sharing boundaries without over-explaining
- giving supporters concrete next steps
- building a week of care that feels manageable

START HERE

You do not need a perfect plan.

Use only the pages that lower the mental load today. Write briefly, leave blanks, change your mind, and invite one trusted person to help coordinate.

1. ## Name the need

   Circle what feels hardest to hold right now. A specific need is easier for someone else to meet.

2. ## Choose a point person

   If possible, ask one supporter to share updates, coordinate offers, or protect your boundaries.

3. ## Send one clear message

   Use the ready-to-send language in this kit. You do not have to compose the perfect request.

4. ## Review, do not manage

   Let the plan carry information so you can spend less energy repeating yourself.

A useful first question

"What would make the next 24 hours feel a little lighter?"

WORKSHEET 01

What I Actually Need

Circle or check anything that would genuinely help. Cross out anything that would create more work. There is no correct list.

PRACTICAL CARE

- [ ] A meal ready to eat
- [ ] Groceries or essentials
- [ ] Laundry or dishes
- [ ] A school or activity run
- [ ] An errand handled
- [ ] A quiet hour at home

CONNECTION

- [ ] A text with no reply needed
- [ ] A short phone call
- [ ] Company without hosting
- [ ] Help updating others
- [ ] A walk or fresh air
- [ ] Space without questions

SOMETHING ELSE I NEED

WHAT WOULD NOT HELP RIGHT NOW

WORKSHEET 02

My right-now priorities

A short list protects your energy. Choose the few things that matter most this week, not everything that could be done.

IF ONLY ONE THING GETS EASIER

The one task, worry, or decision that would create the most breathing room:

THREE HELPFUL ACTIONS

Specific things another person can take ownership of without waiting for instructions:

WHAT CAN WAIT

Tasks or expectations that are allowed to be unfinished for now:

WHO CAN COORDINATE

A person who can answer questions or connect offers of help to this plan:

WORKSHEET 03

Meals and groceries

Make food support easier to give and easier to receive. Share this page with the person coordinating meals.

FOODS THAT WORK WELL

Meals, snacks, drinks, or grocery staples we would genuinely use:

PLEASE AVOID

Allergies, intolerances, strong dislikes, or foods we already have too much of:

DELIVERY DETAILS

Best drop-off days/times, where to leave food, and whether a visit is welcome:

A SIMPLE OFFER SUPPORTERS CAN SEND

"I can bring dinner Tuesday or Thursday. Would either help? I can leave it at the door, and no reply beyond the day is needed."

WHO IS COORDINATING MEALS?

Name and preferred contact method:

WORKSHEET 04

Home, errands, and logistics

Support is often most useful when someone owns a complete task. Choose only what feels comfortable to hand off.

AT HOME

- [ ] Laundry from hamper to folded
- [ ] Dishes and kitchen reset
- [ ] Trash and recycling
- [ ] Pet care
- [ ] School or activity pickup

OUT AND ABOUT

- [ ] Grocery pickup
- [ ] Pharmacy or store run
- [ ] Package return
- [ ] Appointment ride
- [ ] Update family or friends

HELPFUL DETAILS

Keys, access, preferences, timing, or instructions that prevent follow-up questions:

A TASK SOMEONE CAN FULLY OWN

From start to finish, without asking me to manage each step:

WORKSHEET 05

Visitors and boundaries

A boundary is useful information. It helps caring people show up in a way that protects the household instead of adding decisions.

RIGHT NOW, VISITS FEEL

- [ ] Welcome
- [ ] Welcome if planned
- [ ] Helpful only for a task
- [ ] Not right now

Best visit length or time of day: _____

BEFORE COMING OVER

Please text/call, bring something, avoid ringing the bell, or know this first:

_____

_____

_____

WHILE YOU ARE HERE

What would feel caring? What would create extra work? What topics are off-limits today?

_____

_____

_____

_____

READY-TO-SEND BOUNDARY

"We would love to see you, and short planned visits work best right now. Please text before coming. We may need to reschedule, and we appreciate your flexibility."

WORKSHEET 06

Check-ins that feel supportive

The best kind of contact can change from day to day. Give supporters a few simple ways to stay connected without creating pressure to respond.

CONTACT THAT WORKS

Text, call, voice note, brief visit, group update, or something else:

A USEFUL RHYTHM

Daily, every few days, weekly, or only when I reach out:

MESSAGES THAT ASK LESS AND OFFER MORE

"Thinking of you. No reply needed."

"I am at the store. Send one item if you want; silence is okay too."

"Would a 10-minute call feel good, or would you rather have quiet?"

"I can handle school pickup Wednesday. May I take that off your list?"

WHAT I WANT PEOPLE TO KNOW

A short update one person can share so I do not have to repeat it:

SUPPORT-PERSON GUIDE

How to be the point person

Your job is not to fix everything. It is to reduce questions, translate offers into useful action, and protect the person's stated preferences.

1. ## Ask once, record the answer

   Keep the plan somewhere supporters can use it. Avoid making her repeat preferences to each person.

2. ## Turn vague offers into options

   Instead of "Let me know," offer two concrete choices with a graceful way to decline.

3. ## Own the follow-through

   If you take a task, complete the planning, reminders, and cleanup unless she asks to be involved.

4. ## Protect changing boundaries

   A yes yesterday can be a no today. Share updates without asking her to justify the change.

5. ## Notice the invisible work

   Look for coordination, messages, supplies, cleanup, and decisions that can be carried by someone else.

Helpful support respects consent, privacy, culture, household routines, and the right to change course.

WORKSHEET 07

My weekly village

Put names next to complete, realistic actions. Leave room for rest and change. A small reliable plan is more helpful than a crowded one.

DAY	WHO	WHAT THEY OWN	DETAILS / TIME
MON			
TUE			
WED			
THU			
FRI			
SAT			
SUN			

BACKUP PLAN

If plans change, who should be contacted and what can be skipped?

COPY, EDIT, SEND

Ready-to-send messages

Use these words as a starting point. Clear is kind. Short is enough. You never need to share more than feels comfortable.

ASKING ONE PERSON TO COORDINATE

Could you help me coordinate support this week? I would send you the few things that would help, and you could be the point person for anyone who offers.

ACCEPTING A SPECIFIC OFFER

Yes, that would help. Thursday around 5 works. Please leave it at the door, and no visit is needed this time.

TURNING A VAGUE OFFER INTO ACTION

Thank you. The most helpful options right now are a grocery pickup or taking care of laundry. Would either work for you?

DECLINING WITHOUT EXPLAINING

Thank you for thinking of us. That is not what we need right now, but I appreciate the care behind the offer.

COPY, EDIT, SEND

More messages for changing days

Support plans should flex with real life. These notes make it easier to update people without reopening every decision.

PAUSING VISITS

We are taking a quieter few days and pausing visits. We will reach out when that changes. Doorstep drop-offs are still welcome.

ASKING FOR A CHECK-IN

Could you text me tomorrow afternoon? I may not reply right away, but knowing you will check in would feel supportive.

FOR A LONG-DISTANCE SUPPORTER

If you would like to help from afar, a grocery delivery or taking one phone call off my list would be genuinely useful.

SHARING THE PLAN

We made a simple support plan so we do not have to coordinate each offer from scratch. Here is what would help and who to contact.

WORKSHEET 08

A practical wishlist

Useful care can be small, local, delivered, or done from far away. List options at different effort and price levels so supporters can choose honestly.

NO-COST HELP

Calls to make, messages to send, errands, rides, pet care, laundry, or a check-in:

UNDER $20

A grocery staple, prepared food, delivery fee, household essential, or small comfort:

GROUP GIFT

A larger need several people could share, without creating extra management for us:

FROM FAR AWAY

Delivery, a local service, coordinating the schedule, or another task that does not require a visit:

WORKSHEET 09

Important contacts

Keep only the contacts you want a trusted support person to have. Store this page somewhere private and update it when needed.

PERSON / ROLE	BEST CONTACT	WHEN TO REACH THEM

WHERE THIS PLAN LIVES

Who has access, and where is the current version kept?

BRING IT TOGETHER

One small next step

A village can begin with one person, one honest need, and one concrete action. You do not have to coordinate the whole future today.

THE NEED I WANT TO NAME

What would make the next day or week feel lighter?

THE PERSON I CAN ASK

Who feels safe, reliable, and able to hear a specific request?

THE MESSAGE I WILL SEND

Keep it short. Use one of the scripts in this kit if words feel hard.

Plans can change. Needs can change. Boundaries can change.

The purpose of this kit is to carry information, not create another standard to meet.

KEEP NEARBY

A note to the people showing up

Practical care is not about doing the most. It is about paying attention, asking clearly, following through, and respecting the answer.

> *Offer something specific. Make no the easiest answer. Take ownership of the details. Do not require gratitude, updates, or a visit in return. Let care feel like less to carry.*

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Every woman deserves a village.

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